

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3233

Name

Kaan Mika

Emailmikakaan@gmail.com**Gender**

Male

City, state, and country of residence

Zurich, Switzerland

Nationality

Turkish

When did or will you finish your PhD?

October 2020

University Education

Post-doctoral Researcher, Department of Environmental Systems Science, ETH Zurich, Switzerland | 4/2022- Current

PhD in Life Sciences, University of Lausanne, Switzerland | 11/2015-10/2020

Research intern, Molecular biology, University of Lausanne; Lausanne, Switzerland | 1/2015-11/2015

Master's degree in Molecular biology, Boğaziçi University, Turkey | 8/2012 - 11/2014

Exchange Student in Molecular biology, Roskilde University, Denmark | 9/2010 - 6/2011

Bachelor's Degree in Molecular Biology and Genetics, Istanbul Technical University | 9/2007 - 6/2012

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I am enthusiastic about the Science Corps Fellowship because it perfectly aligns with my strong background in science and my passion for science communication. As a recent STEM PhD graduate, I have acquired in-depth knowledge in molecular biology and insect chemosensation, and I am eager to share this expertise with underserved communities.

Throughout my academic journey, I honed my science communication skills by presenting complex concepts to diverse audiences, including school children, students, peers, and the public. I firmly believe that effective science education is not just about teaching facts but also about sparking curiosity and fostering critical thinking.

I am committed to leveraging my scientific background and communication abilities to design engaging curriculum, teach, host workshops, and demonstrate experiments that provide hands-on STEM experiences. By doing so, I aim to inspire students and empower them to pursue STEM fields.

Science Corps offers a unique platform to merge my love for science with my dedication to education, and I am excited to contribute to its mission of building STEM capacity worldwide. I am ready to make a meaningful impact, one classroom at a time, and motivate future generations to explore the wonders of science.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

I'm driven by an unwavering passion for storytelling and a deep-seated desire to share knowledge. With over a decade of research experience, I've combined my expertise with social media finesse to become an influential science communicator on Instagram, reaching thousands daily. This journey has honed my communication skills, allowing me to tailor messages precisely to their intended audience.

Beyond science, I've mastered photography, video production, website development, and social media management—tools that can supercharge Science Corps' reach. I see an incredible opportunity to attract more PhD graduates and donors to the cause, exponentially expanding its impact.

My profound connection with nature has led me to explore forests, capturing the beauty of insects and plants. My passion for biodiversity and entomology drives me to share captivating facts with children, igniting their curiosity about the natural world.

Beyond science, I'm a devoted traveler, having explored 65+ countries, gathering stories that can captivate children's imaginations. I believe travel liberates us, and I aim to inspire the next generation to embark on their own journeys of discovery.

In essence, I'm wholeheartedly motivated to join the Science Corps Fellowship. My storytelling, social media skills, love for nature, and passion for global

exploration are a perfect fit for Science Corps' mission. Together, we can fuel young minds, kindle a love for science and nature, and empower future leaders to explore our boundless world.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

The recent years have been a transformative journey for me, one that has crystallized my passions and purpose in life. I've gained clarity on what resonates with me and where I can make the most profound impact – in the realm of science communication, particularly in the field of biology.

Looking ahead, in just two years, I envision myself immersed in enriching roles at scientific institutes, museums, and science magazines, all dedicated to the noble pursuit of science communication. I will channel my passion into collaborative projects that bring the wonders of biology to a wider audience. Concurrently, I'll continue my independent journey as a science communicator on Instagram, expanding my reach to platforms like TikTok and YouTube, connecting with diverse audiences to inspire scientific curiosity.

Fast forward a decade, and my aspirations take on a grander scale. I envision myself as the director of an international organization, leading a global movement to make science accessible, especially in developing countries. Through innovative and impactful initiatives, we'll empower young minds worldwide with the knowledge and wonder of science. This vision propels me forward, and I am driven to use my skills and experiences to create a brighter, more scientifically literate future for all.

The Science Corps Fellowship offers an invaluable opportunity to enhance my science communication journey, providing a solid foundation to realize these aspirations. With your support, I'm determined to leave an enduring mark on the world, igniting the flame of curiosity and knowledge in the hearts of countless young minds across the globe.

CV/Resume

 [KaanMika CV.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

My desired date of start is 1.5.2024 and I am interested in joining to Central Visayan Institute Foundation (CVIF) Jagna (Bohol), Philippines. If this isn't possible, my second choice would be to teach at Aavishkaar Palampur (Himalayas), India. My third choice would be The American School of Tangier (AST) Tangier, Morocco.

[Science Corps](#)